

UNIT 5 / Time and daily life

Tell the time

Your goal: Understand full hours, half hours and appointment times.

01 Learn the idea

For clear official times, use the hour followed by Uhr and the minutes: acht Uhr dreißig. Ask Wie spät ist es? for the current time. Say um acht Uhr to explain when an event starts. The 24-hour clock is common in timetables: 14 Uhr is two in the afternoon.

In everyday speech, halb neun means 8:30, halfway towards nine, not 9:30. Viertel nach acht is 8:15 and Viertel vor neun is 8:45. Regional forms vary; the official hour-and-minutes form is a reliable alternative. Always check whether someone is asking the current time or the time of an event.

Words and phrases

German	English
Wie spät ist es?	What time is it?
Es ist acht Uhr.	It is eight o'clock.
halb neun	half past eight
um vierzehn Uhr	at two p.m.
Viertel nach acht	quarter past eight

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Mia

Wann beginnt der Kurs?

When does the course begin?

Ben

Um halb neun.

At half past eight.

Mia

Also um acht Uhr dreißig?

So at eight thirty?

Ben

Ja, genau.

Yes, exactly.

Your real-life mission

Write 08:00, 08:15, 08:30 and 14:00 in words. Give an appointment time using um and repeat it in another form where possible.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Wie spät ist es?” mean?

- A. It is eight o'clock.
- B. half past eight
- C. What time is it?

2. What does “Es ist acht Uhr.” mean?

- A. It is eight o'clock.
- B. half past eight
- C. at two p.m.

3. What does “halb neun” mean?

- A. at two p.m.
- B. half past eight
- C. quarter past eight

4. What time is halb neun?

- A. 09:30
- B. 08:30
- C. 09:00

5. When does the course begin?

- A. 08:30
- B. 14:00
- C. 08:15

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - What time is it?

“Wie spät ist es?” means “What time is it?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - It is eight o'clock.

“Es ist acht Uhr.” means “It is eight o'clock.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - half past eight

“halb neun” means “half past eight”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. B - 08:30

German half-hour expressions look ahead to the next hour.

5. A - 08:30

Ben confirms acht Uhr dreißig.

One possible mission response

acht Uhr; Viertel nach acht; halb neun; vierzehn Uhr. Der Kurs beginnt um acht Uhr dreißig.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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